Winchester Planning Board

Fall Town Meeting

November 5, 2026

Articles 4, 5 & 6

Simplifying the Zoning Bylaws

WINCHESTER, MA

PLANNING BOARD

Article 4: Reduce confusion

Amend Section 3.5.5: Nonconforming Uses and Structures

- Adds “insufficient lot width” to the circumstances under which a change to a conforming structure on a nonconforming lot may be permitted

Amend Section 4.1.1: Table of Dimensional Requirements

- Reduces the minimum lot width in the residential district A (RDA) from 120 feet to 100 to achieve consistency throughout the section

These changes will help residents modernize their homes with less administrative hassle

- As currently constituted, the “nonconforming uses & structures” is confusing
- Expect to introduce more comprehensive changes to Section 3.5 in the Spring

Article 5: Simplify the process

Amend Section 7.3: Center Business District

Delete all references to “Center Business District Review Subcommittee” and “CBDRS” from Section 7.3.15

- In the past 11 years, the work of the CBDRS has proven to be redundant, forcing applicants to go through four board reviews
- Elimination would simplify the process, saving applicants time and money, helping ensure quicker reviews through only three boards
- Endorsed by Historical Commission and Design Review Committee

Article 6: Save more trees

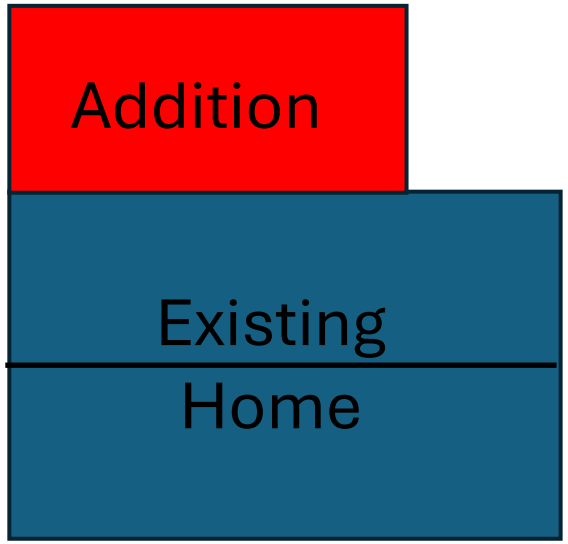
Amend Sections 9.4.3, 9.5.4 (Special Permits) and 9.5.5

- Removes the requirement to provide multiple hard copies of proposal and all backup paperwork
  - It's time to join the 21st century

Also amend Section 9.5.5

- Extends the transmittal period from three to five days
- Provides that site plan review and special permit will be combined in a single hearing and decision

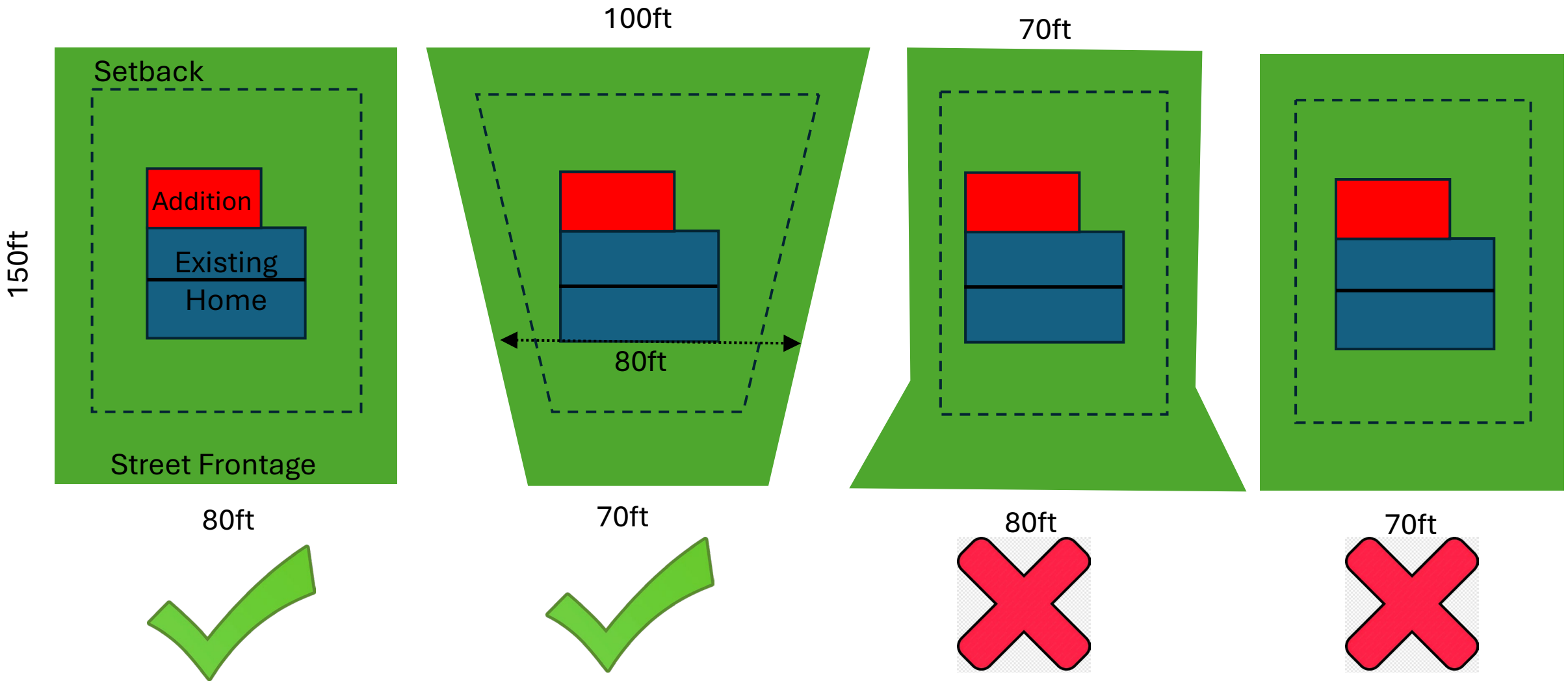
Article 4: Can you currently build the addition by right in RDB?



RDB Zoning Requires

- 10,000 sq feet
- 80 ft lot frontage
- 80 ft lot width
- 25 ft front setback
- 15 ft side and rear setbacks

Article 4: Can you currently build the addition by right in RDB?



Article 4: Excerpt from Table 4.1.1

Table of Dimensional Requirements											
DISTRICT	**RA (r)**	**RB (r)**	**RDA (g) (q)**	**RDB (g) (q)**	**RDC (q)**	**RG**	**CBD (n)**	**GBD-1(s)**	**MSMD**	**IL**	**SCI**
Min. Lot Frontage (in feet)	200	75 (b)	100 (b)	80 (b)	100 (b)	65 (b) (h)	See 7.3.12	20	See 8.12.5	100	NR
Min. Lot Width (in feet)	200	75	120	80	100	65 (h)	See 7.3.12	20	See 8.12.5	100	NR